

001

DEEP TIME

A Journey Of Self-Construction And Self-Identification

This mixed media AR video art installation combines 3D renderings and physical installations to explore my journey of self-construction and self-identification. By collecting places and objects from my memories, I visualize key moments in time, capturing their essence and evoking empathy from viewers.

The physical component incorporates the connection between smell and memory, integrating olfactory elements to enhance the immersive experience. By merging the virtual and physical, the installation creates a multi-sensory exploration of my personal journey.

This project is both a reflection on collective memory and a deeply personal process of self-identification and shared understanding with my mother. It reveals that every experience from the past has shaped the unique person I am today.

Tools:
UE5

Cinema 4D

Contribution:
Individual Project

Interactive installation,
12950mmx11740mmx4
000mm, 3 projectors,9
gauze screens,

4-7 February 2023

Background

Sounds and **smells** are the most powerful search engines in everyone's memory, and they can conjure up thousands of pounds of memories.

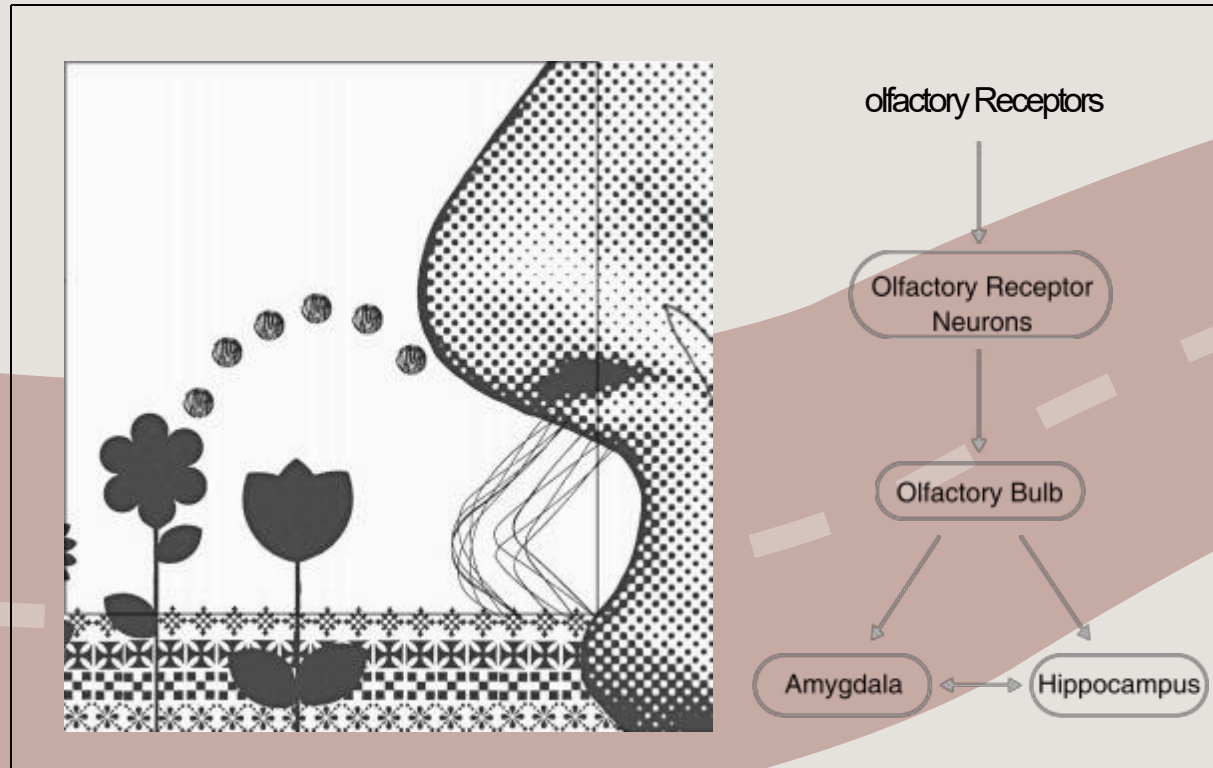
I realized that there were **moments in my memory** that were very important to my personality formation and self-identification process. For example, the first time I started to express my inner thoughts to my mother, the first time I learned to swim, the first time I came out to my mother, the first time I self-identified, and so on.



Research

The proustian Effect

The Proustian Effect refers to the idea that **smelling** a familiar odor can instantly **bring back memories of the past**.



Amplify The Feelings of The Moment

The Proustian Effect allowed me to determine how I could **express my personal emotional memories more visually and concretely**. ---- Images from my memory combined with the sounds and flavors of the moment The sounds and flavors of the moment.

Dream core

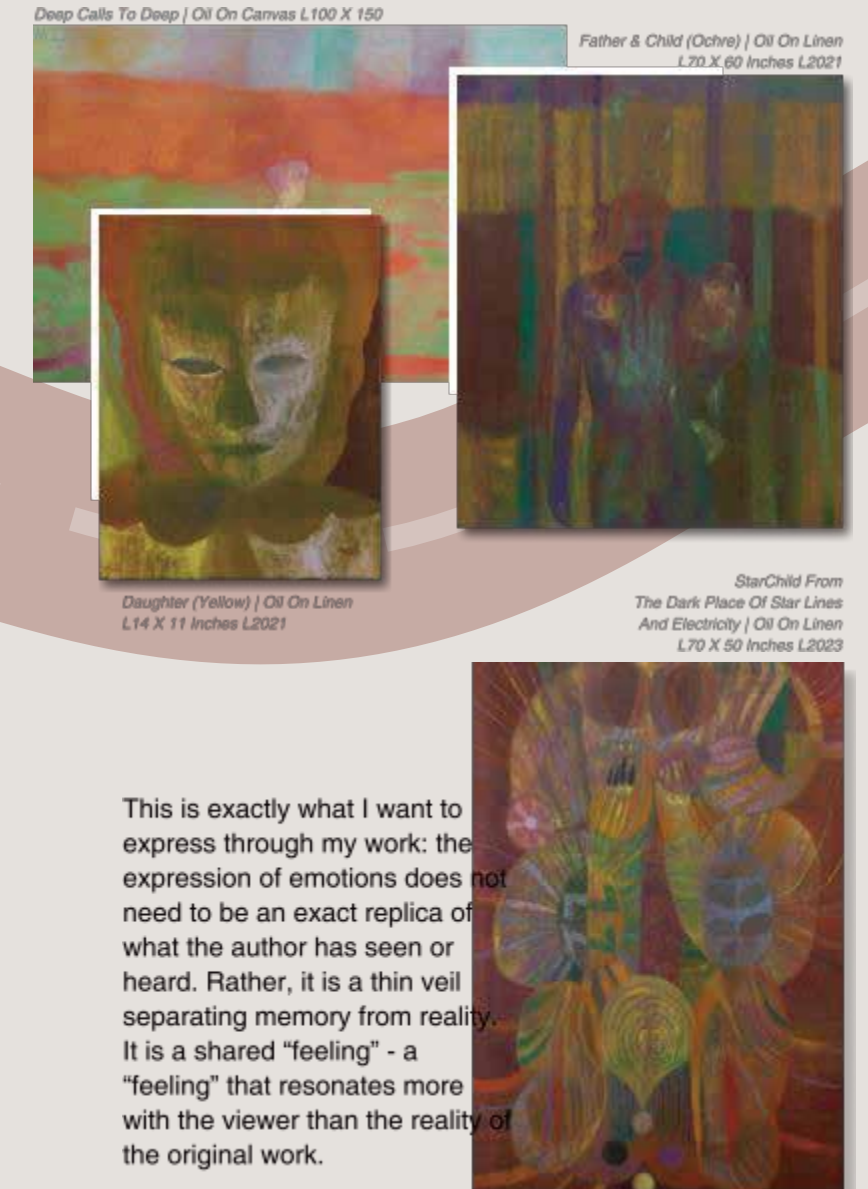
Dreamcore works usually give an eerie sense of dislocation. They are a constant reminder that this is not reality and that something is not right.



post-Millennial china's old Time core

It's a style I want to develop, incorporating dreamcore but removing the spooky elements, leaving only a soothing background with a touch of melancholy nostalgia. It's rooted in the social objects of China from 2005 to 2015, evoking a sense of déjà vu—familiar yet empty, like low-resolution childhood memories of China's millennials.

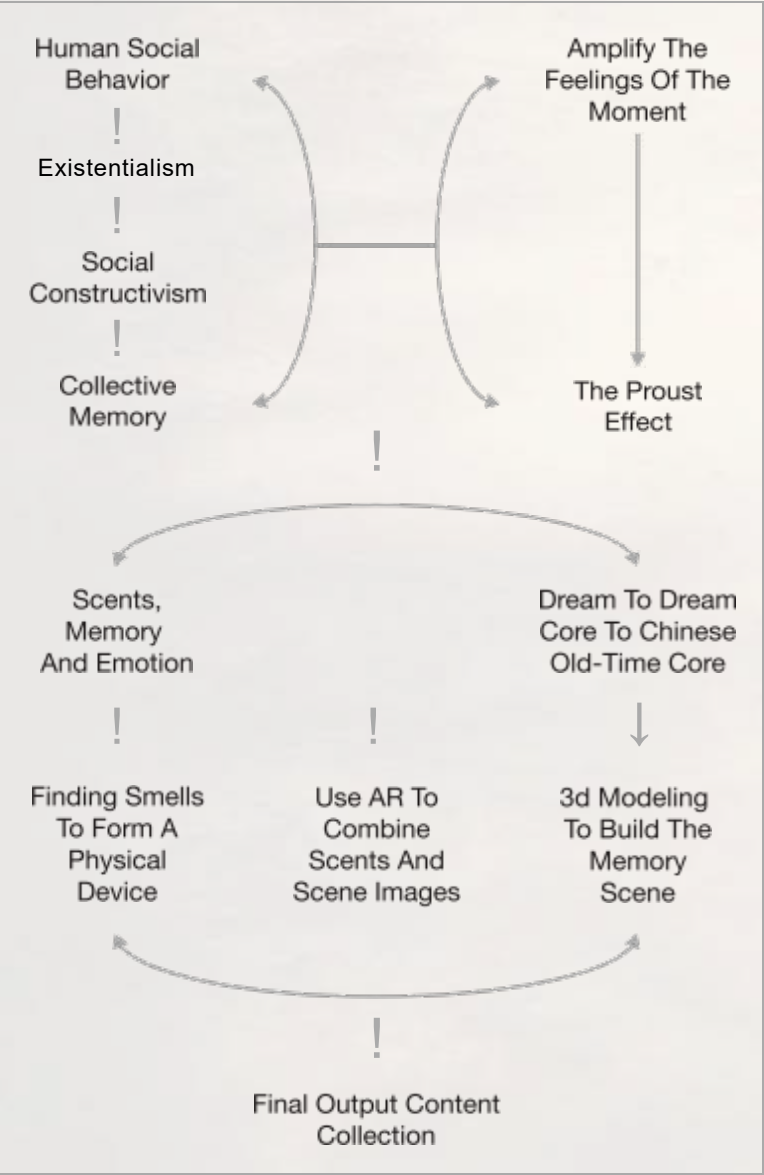
Maja Euznic's work



This is exactly what I want to express through my work: the expression of emotions does not need to be an exact replica of what the author has seen or heard. Rather, it is a thin veil separating memory from reality. It is a shared "feeling" - a "feeling" that resonates more with the viewer than the reality of the original work.

Design process

Mind Map



project production process

I have chosen five memory scenes that are very special to me, which will be the main body of my project, and a few important points that best express my personal growth.

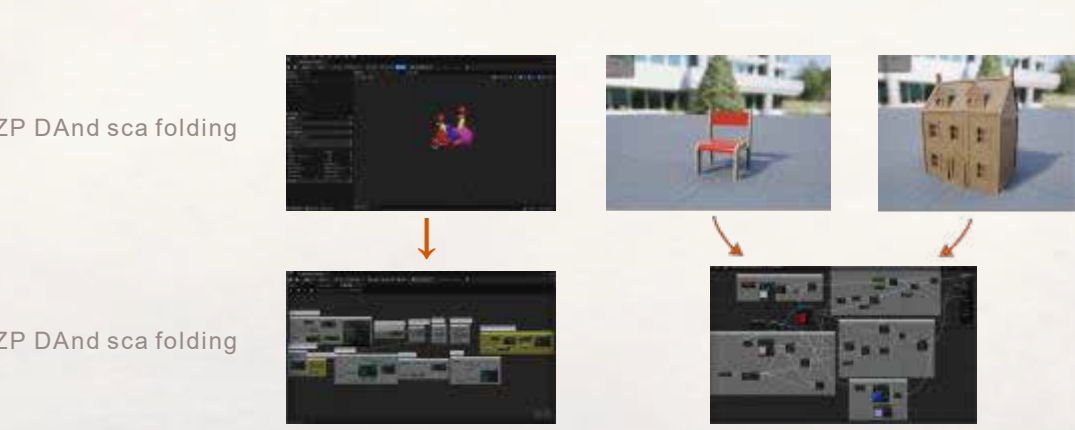
part I:Memories of kindergarten

66

This memory dates back to my kindergarten days: stepping out of the classroom after lunch recess, feeling unwell, receiving my afternoon snack from the teacher, and waving goodbye as the warm autumn light streamed through the floor-to-ceiling windows.

This memory reinforces my sense of personal security, serving as a constant reminder that "I am surrounded by love."

Making Process



part2:Memories of passageway ofAn old Building

Making process

“

One snowy day, I came home late after playing for too long, without a way to communicate, leaving my mom in tears, not knowing where I had been. That day, I got my first cell phone. I still recall the cold wind, the smell of her leather coat, and the winter dust. This memory taught me the importance of staying connected with loved ones and developing empathy by considering others' feelings.

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For this scene, I created materials inspired by old Chinese items to evoke a strong sense of "Chinese old-time nostalgia."

Making process



part3:Memories of Learning To swim ASA child

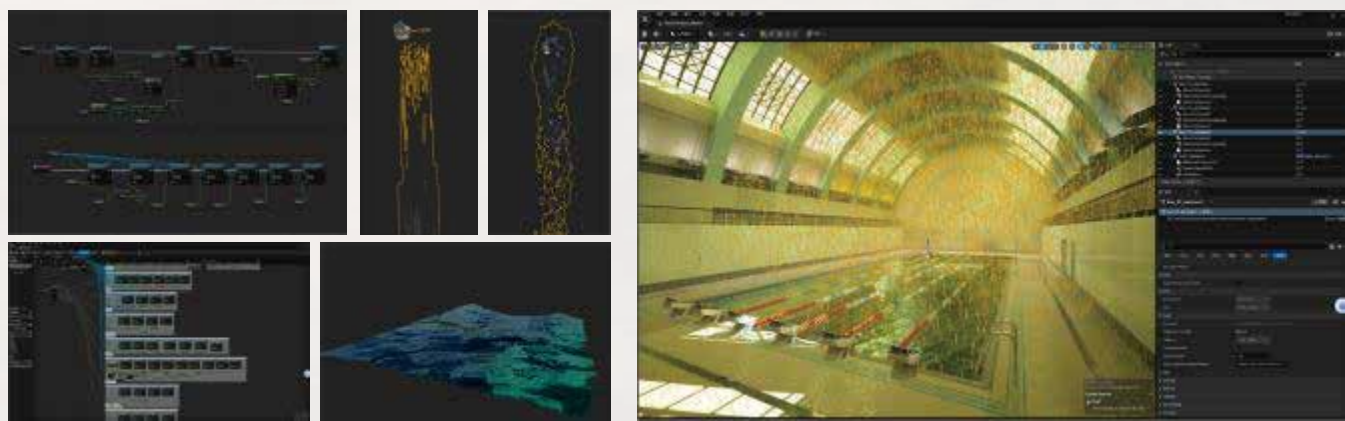
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In elementary school, I attended swimming lessons every summer morning in an unheated pool. The cool morning breeze left me shivering before the trainer pushed me into the water. Sound became muffled as I plunged in, holding my breath, and in an instant, I learned to swim.

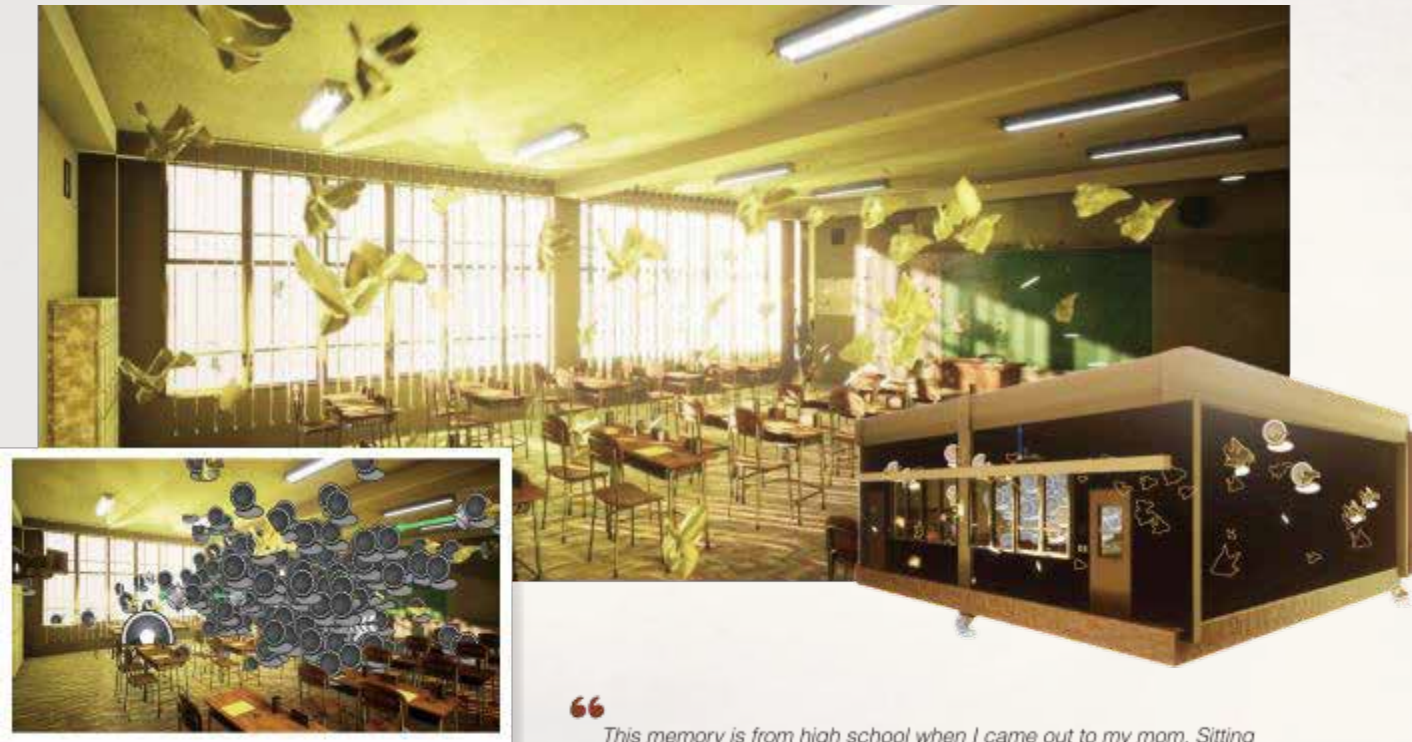
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Making process



part4:Memories of coming out In Highschool



“ This memory is from high school when I came out to my mom. Sitting in a noisy classroom, my mind was in chaos, but I found the courage to tell her I was gay. Over time, she grew to support me, marking the start of my self-identification and the journey to building my “true self.”

Making process

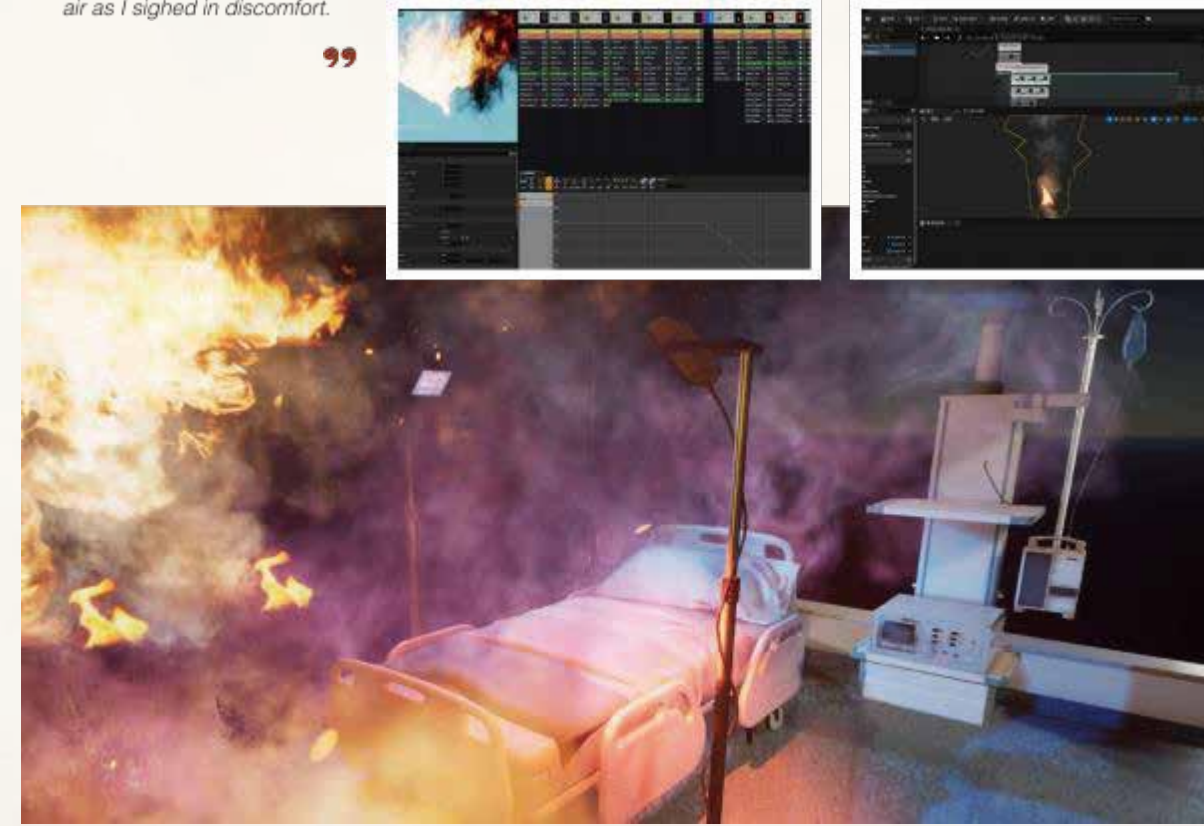


For this scene, I used uE5'S Niagara system to visualize the chaotic environment and inner turmoil.

part5:Memories of Being critically Ill

“ Before high school, my immunity weakened, and I developed shingles that required three months of recovery. One spring afternoon, I lay on the treatment bed under red light, sweating as my clothes clung to me. The sound of therapy machines filled the air as I sighed in discomfort.

Making process



For this scene, I used UE5's Niagara system to simulate flames, representing the inner burning and physical heat I experienced.

part 6:AR Video Realization



I used ARTIVIVE to integrate AR video. First, I created an AR video linked to a specific image. Then, I uploaded both the video and the image to the ARTIVIVE platform. Once set up, viewers can use the ARTIVIVE app to watch the AR video I created by scanning the image.

part 7:physical Installation Material collection



For each scene, I sought out the scents tied to my memories—like the earthy aroma of winter soil, the chlorine of a swimming pool, or the crisp fragrance of the wind. These smells formed the "scent" component of the Proust Effect for this project.

outcome





Exhibition

